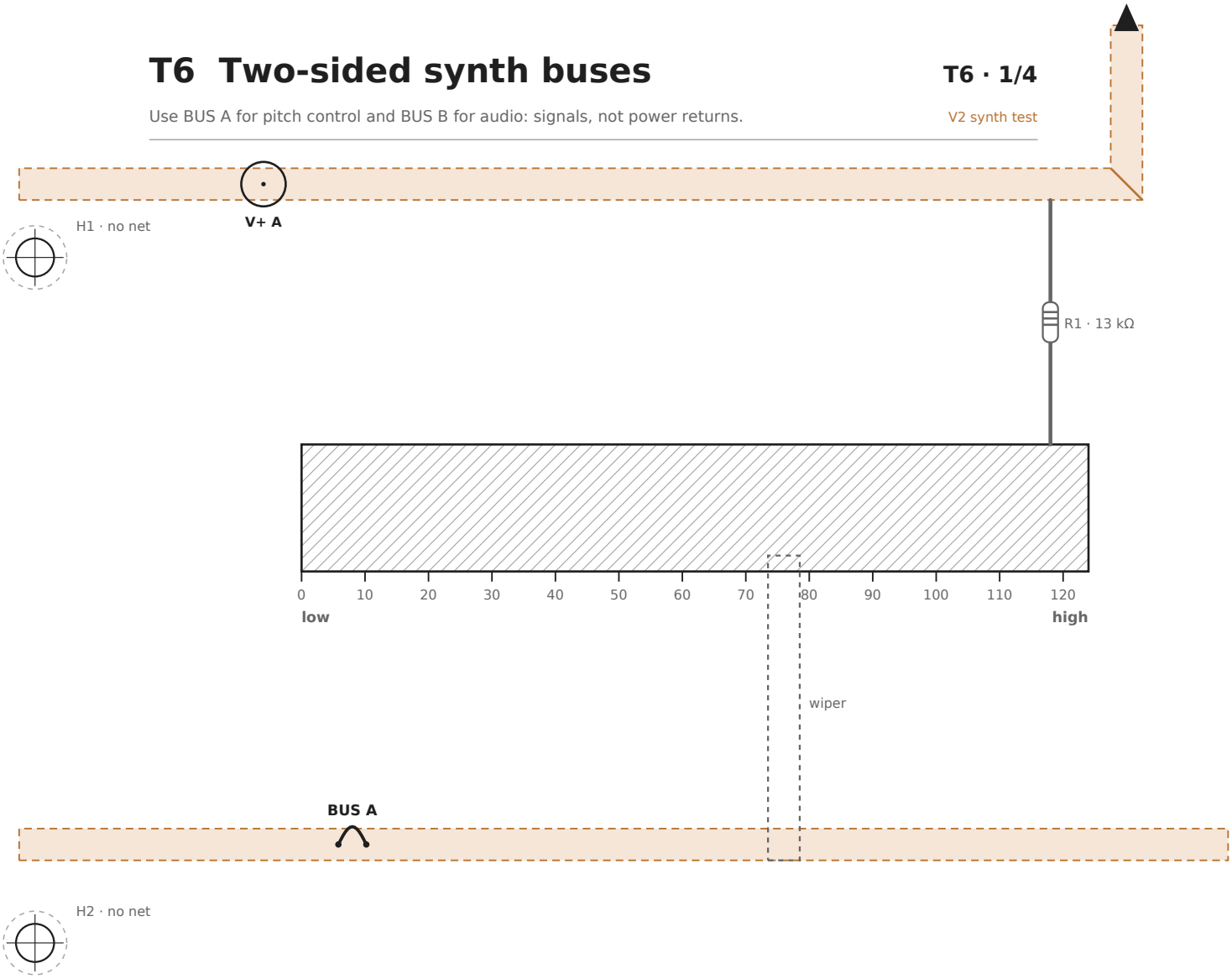
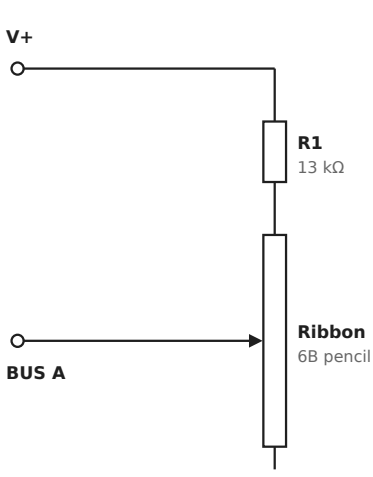
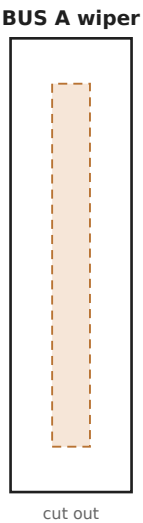
T6 Two-sided synth buses

Use BUS A for pitch control and BUS B for audio: signals, not power returns.



Controller schematic

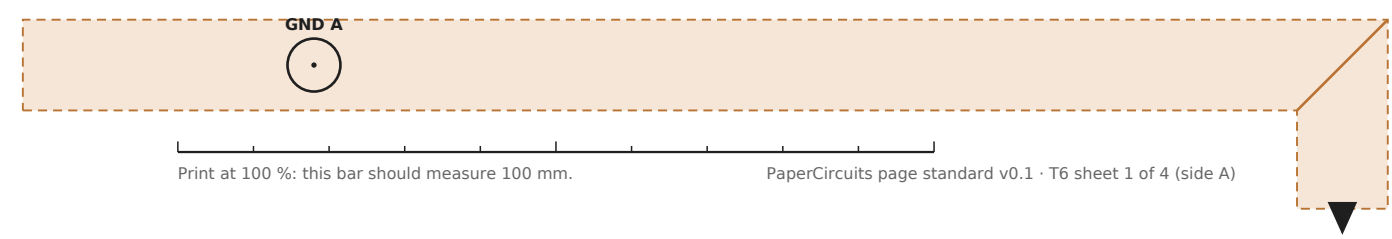




BUS A · pencil pitch controller

Adapted from M3. V+ feeds a 13 kΩ resistor and pencil ribbon. The movable wiper puts the selected resistance onto BUS A for M1's PITCH input.

H3 · no net



T6 Synth bus: side B

BUS B receives audio from M1; V+ and GND arrive through their edge wraps.

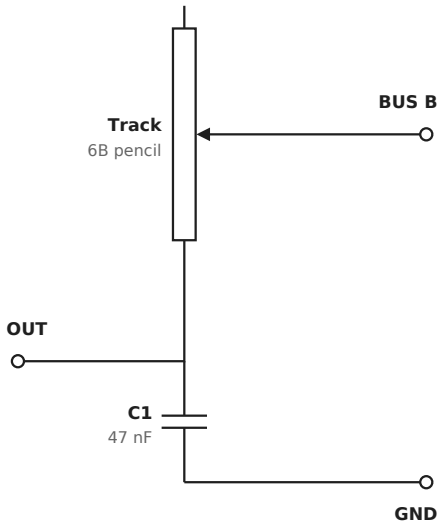
V+ B

H1 · no net

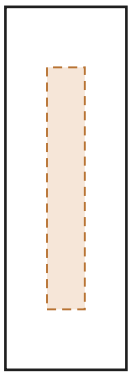
BUS B · pencil tone filter

Adapted from M6. BUS B is the audio input. The wiper selects pencil resistance before OUT, while C1 sends high-frequency buzz to GND. OUT still goes through M7 before an amp.

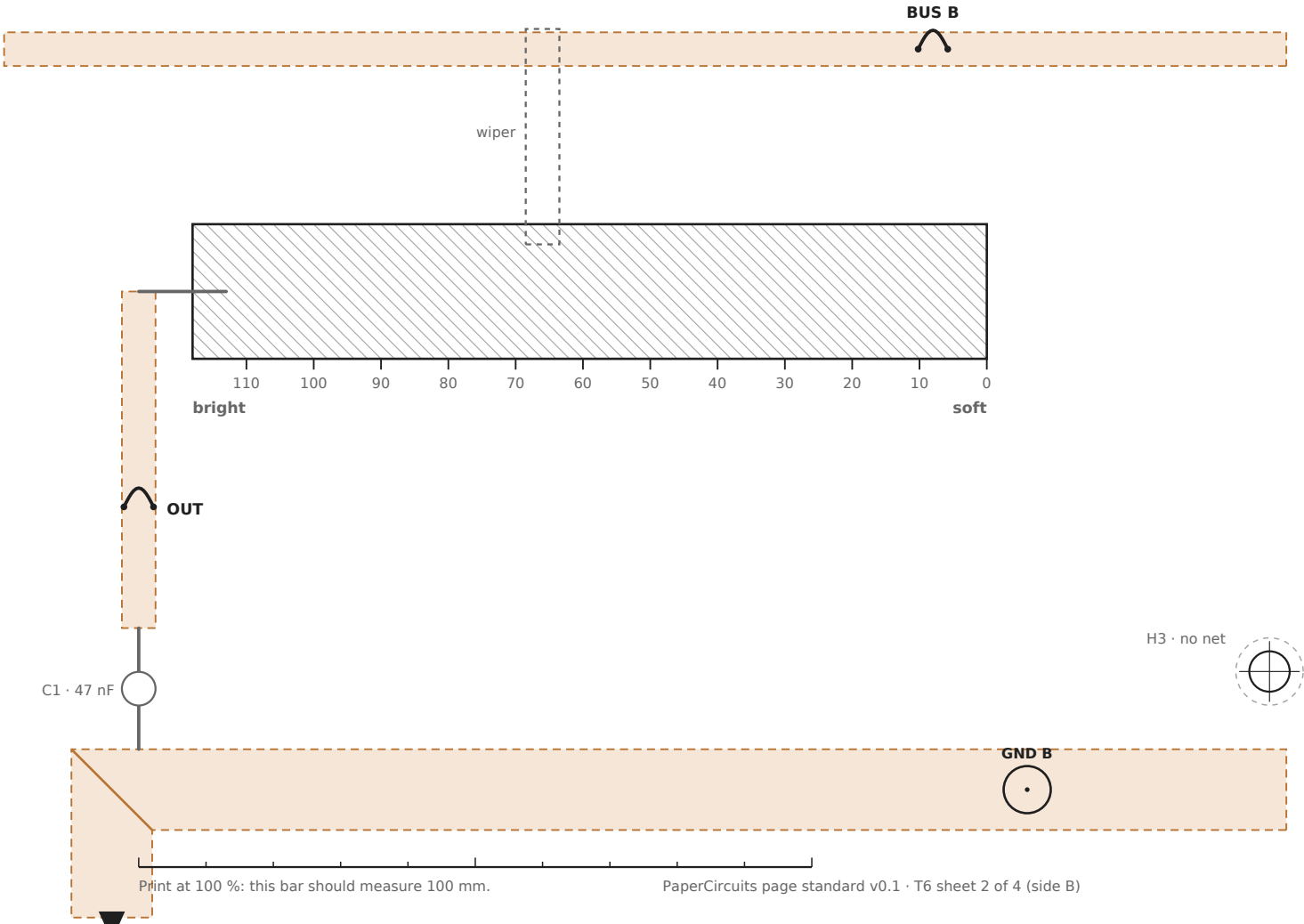
Filter schematic



BUS B wiper



H2 · no net



H3 · no net

Print at 100 %: this bar should measure 100 mm.

T6 Build and test the synth buses

Print sheets 1 and 2 double-sided on card, flipping on the long edge. Print sheets 3 and 4 once.

H1 · no net

You need

- One double-sided card, a three-hole punch and a three-ring binder
- 5 mm copper tape for V+ and the buses; 12 mm copper tape for GND
- R1: 13 kΩ; C1: 47 nF ceramic
- A soft 6B pencil, an eraser, clear tape and card for two wipers
- Solder, clip leads and a multimeter
- Built M1 oscillator and M7 output pages; a powered speaker or amp with a line/AUX input

1 · Print and lay power

1. Check the 100 mm scale bars and side registration. Punch the three mechanical holes.

2. Lay V+ over the top edge and GND over the bottom edge, following the solid arrows.

3. Confirm V+ and GND are continuous face-to-face and read OL between them.

2 · Build side A

1. Lay BUS A only on side A. Shade the ribbon hard with 6B pencil until it shines.

2. Fit R1 from V+ to the ribbon's high end.

3. Cut out the BUS A wiper and tape copper underneath. It must bridge BUS A to the ribbon when pressed.

4. Keep BUS A isolated from V+, GND and every side-B conductor.

3 · Build side B

1. Lay BUS B only on side B. Shade the tone track hard with 6B pencil.

H2 · no net

2. Join the track's bright end to OUT with W1. Fit C1 between OUT and GND.

3. Cut out the BUS B wiper and tape copper underneath. It must bridge BUS B to the track when pressed.

4. Keep BUS B isolated from V+, GND and every side-A conductor.

4 · Patch the synth

1. Power M1, M7 and this card from the same fused 4.5 V supply and common GND.

2. Patch BUS A to M1 PITCH. Press the side-A wiper on the ribbon and BUS A.

3. Patch M1 OUT to BUS B. Patch this card's OUT to M7 IN1.

4. Connect M7 only to a powered speaker's or amp's line/AUX input with its volume low. Never use headphones or a bare speaker.

5 · Test the buses

1. Slide the side-A wiper from high to low. The note must glide down without BUS A powering anything.

2. Hold the pitch steady and slide the side-B wiper from bright to soft. The buzz must soften without BUS B carrying supply current.

3. Remove BUS A: M1 must stop. Restore it, then remove BUS B: the amp must go quiet while M1's LED still shows oscillation.

6 · Flex and inspect

1. Flex both power wraps through 100 cycles, then repeat both signal tests while opening and closing the binder.

2. Record crackle, dropouts, changing pitch or lifted pencil/tape contacts. Repeat at 1,000 cycles if the 100-cycle test passes.

Pass or fail

- **Pass:** BUS A controls pitch, BUS B carries audio, removing either bus breaks only its stated signal path, and flexing causes no dropout.
- **Fail:** either bus acts as power or return, appears across the wrong face, shorts a rail, or requires a through-page via.

H3 · no net

Print at 100 %: this bar should measure 100 mm.

T6 Synth bus results

Record power-wrap resistance and whether each signal bus keeps its one job.

Power-wrap continuity

Measure with power disconnected; V+ to GND must remain OL.

	New	After flex
V+ A-B		
GND A-B		

Functional signal tests

Test	Before	After
BUS A pitch glide		
BUS B tone sweep		

Bus decision

BUS A existed only on side A	
BUS A controlled M1 pitch	
BUS B existed only on side B	
BUS B carried M1 audio	
Removing BUS A stopped M1	
Removing BUS B muted the output	
No bus carried load current	
No page via was required	

Notes

Pitch range and tone change	
Crackle, dropout or flex damage	
Builder / date	